

THE COMET

1930 · Science Correspondence Club, Chicago. The first science fiction fanzine.

WEEK 1 · THE IMAGINARY · SOLARPUNK

READ & ENCOUNTER ARTWORKS

Work through every item listed below. Most sections contain the six questions; the readings on method and the three works contain a single question instead, and the closing section contains two of its own. Every question has to be answered before a section counts as completed.

CONNECTIONS

FIND	something you did not know before
SPARK	what inspired you, specifically
FRICTION	what upset you, and why
LIVED	your own life, and what it shows beyond you
CHARGE	where you stand, said with conviction
SPECULATE	a work that does not exist yet

Due two hours before class.

ENTER YOUR NAME

YOUR NAME

SECTION

DATE

YOUR SUBMISSION NUMBER ARTIST_

Four readings. Each section contains the six questions.

01

READING · 6 QUESTIONS

A Solarpunk Manifesto

→ **Open the item** <https://theanarchistlibrary.org/library/the-solarpunk-community-a-solarpunk-manifesto>

The Solarpunk Community's manifesto, mirrored on The Anarchist Library. Read the whole thing.

FIND

Something you learned that you did not know before. A fact, a quote, a concept, a claim. What is it? Why is it interesting?

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

SPARK

What inspired you? Describe the thing — a sentence, an image, a moment, an object — and why it is inspiring to you.

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

FRICTION

What upset you? Disagreement, irritation, discomfort, or something you think is simply wrong. Describe it and why you responded this way.

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

LIVED

Something in your own life this connects to, and how it connects to the larger world. Two parts: why it relates to your lived experience, then what that experience reveals about other people and the world beyond you.

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

CHARGE

What you feel strongly about in the reading OR something that is connected to the reading that you feel strongly about. Take a position and say it with conviction.

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

SPECULATE

Propose a speculative artwork.

For this question, think of a speculative artwork as something that does not exist yet, described as though it already does. It can be an object, an image, a video, a publication, a performance, a tool, a garment, a machine, a place, an installation, a software or hardware. What makes it speculative is that you haven't made it yet. Describe it as a real thing in the world, as if it existed.

Describe yours in two or three sentences. Describe its parts, aesthetics, concepts, location, interactive elements, technologies, sounds, movement, etc. It does not have to be buildable or possible.

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

FIND

Something you learned that you did not know before. A fact, a quote, a concept, a claim. What is it? Why is it interesting?

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Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

03

READING · 6 QUESTIONS

Williams, Solarpunk: Against a Shitty Future

→ [Open the item](https://lareviewofbooks.org/article/solarpunk-against-a-shitty-future/) <https://lareviewofbooks.org/article/solarpunk-against-a-shitty-future/>

Rhys Williams, Los Angeles Review of Books, 2018.

FIND

Something you learned that you did not know before. A fact, a quote, a concept, a claim. What is it? Why is it interesting?

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

SPARK

What inspired you? Describe the thing — a sentence, an image, a moment, an object — and why it is inspiring to you.

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04

READING · 6 QUESTIONS

Wilk, Is Ornamenting Solar Panels a Crime?

→ **Open the item** <https://www.e-flux.com/architecture/positions/191258/is-ornamenting-solar-panels-a-crime>

Elvia Wilk, e-flux Architecture, 2018.

FIND

Something you learned that you did not know before. A fact, a quote, a concept, a claim. What is it? Why is it interesting?

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

SPARK

What inspired you? Describe the thing — a sentence, an image, a moment, an object — and why it is inspiring to you.

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Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

THE AESTHETIC

Look through both links.

05

LOOK AT · 6 QUESTIONS

What solarpunk looks like

→ [Aesthetics Wiki, Solarpunk](https://aesthetics.fandom.com/wiki/Solarpunk) <https://aesthetics.fandom.com/wiki/Solarpunk>

→ [Solarpunks.club, Art](https://www.solarpunks.club/art) <https://www.solarpunks.club/art>

Look through both. One is a fan-written encyclopedia entry, the other a community gallery. Neither is a scholarly source, but they do provide insights.

FIND

Something you learned that you did not know before. A fact, a quote, a concept, a claim. What is it? Why is it interesting?

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

SPARK

What inspired you? Describe the thing — a sentence, an image, a moment, an object — and why it is inspiring to you.

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Describe yours in two or three sentences. Describe its parts, aesthetics, concepts, location, interactive elements, technologies, sounds, movement, etc. It does not have to be buildable or possible.

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

DESIGN FICTION

Skim these. Each of these sections contains one question, not six.

06

READING · ONE QUESTION

Bleecker, Design Fiction

→ [Open the item](https://nearfuturelaboratory.com/blog/2009/03/design-fiction-a-short-essay-on-design-science-fact-and-fiction/) <https://nearfuturelaboratory.com/blog/2009/03/design-fiction-a-short-essay-on-design-science-fact-and-fiction/>

Julian Bleecker, 2009. Skim and look at ideas, projects, and pictures.

RETHINK

Pick 1 paragraph from this article. How can you rethink an idea from it in a “solarpunk” way?

Quote or paraphrase the paragraph first, then rethink it.

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

Dunne & Raby, Speculative Everything

→ **Open the item** <https://readings.design/PDF/speculative-everything.pdf>

2013. Skim. This is a whole book. Move through it looking at the projects and pictures.

RETHINK

Pick 1 paragraph from this book. How can you rethink an idea from it in a “solarpunk” way?

Quote or paraphrase the paragraph first, then rethink it.

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

THE ARTWORKS & VIDEO

Watch and look. Each of these sections contains one question, not six.

Dear Alice, The Line for Chobani

→ **Open the item** <https://thelinestudio.com/work/chobani>

2021, 1:30.

TAKE

Watch this video. Find something inspiring in it. Use this thing as a jumping off point for a new idea from your perspective. The thing can be an image, a movement, a sound, an object, a moment. Describe the thing and what you would create.

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

- [ACE / AAP](https://jeyifo.us/ACE-AAP) <https://jeyifo.us/ACE-AAP>
- [PIONEER](https://jeyifo.us/PIONEER) <https://jeyifo.us/PIONEER>
- [MoMA](https://www.moma.org/artists/131884-olalekan-jeyifous) <https://www.moma.org/artists/131884-olalekan-jeyifous>
- [LIVING](https://jeyifo.us/LIVING) <https://jeyifo.us/LIVING>
- [TED, megacity gallery](https://ideas.ted.com/gallery-an-intriguing-sci-fi-vision-of-a-megacity/) <https://ideas.ted.com/gallery-an-intriguing-sci-fi-vision-of-a-megacity/>
- [SMS](https://jeyifo.us/SMS) <https://jeyifo.us/SMS>
- [EUNIC Namibia Cluster Fund](https://eunic.eu/projects/namibia-cluster-fund-2024-1) <https://eunic.eu/projects/namibia-cluster-fund-2024-1>

Pick one and go deep rather than skimming all seven.

SPECULATE

Pick one of these artworks to look closely at. What aesthetics do you find inspiring? What concepts do you find inspiring? If you had to speculate about an artwork that you would make, inspired by this artwork and with a solarpunk lens, what would it be? Describe it in detail.

It can be in a different medium than the one used in this piece. Say which piece you picked.

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

- [Ars Electronica](https://ars.electronica.art/export/en/synthetic-messenger/) <https://ars.electronica.art/export/en/synthetic-messenger/>
- [Artists' page](https://tegabrain.com/Synthetic-Messenger) <https://tegabrain.com/Synthetic-Messenger>

Tega Brain and Sam Lavigne, 2021. Read both pages.

SPECULATE

Look at this artwork. It is not necessarily “solarpunk”. How can you take something about this artwork and make your own recreation of a part of it in a “solarpunk” way? Describe a speculative artwork (one that doesn’t exist yet and can even be impossible) that you would make using this piece as a jumping off point.

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

CONCLUSION

Three questions about the week as a whole. Answer them once everything above is done.

11

WRITE · 3 QUESTIONS

Overall thoughts on Solarpunk as a frame

Answer all three questions last, once you have worked through everything above.

OVERALL

Write around 5 sentences about your overall thoughts about how Solarpunk can help to frame discussions about digital media art and climate change, ecology, nature, and our planet. In what ways can it be a useful frame for digital media artists to make and discuss digital artwork?

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

BEYOND

Which disciplines outside of art do the ideas in Solarpunk connect to? Pick one or two, from this list or from anywhere else:

architecture and urban planning · agriculture and food systems · engineering and energy · biology and ecology · computer science and machine learning · economics and labor · law and policy · public health · education · anthropology · geology and climate science · supply chains and logistics · disability studies · philosophy and religion

Next, describe how or why you picked that discipline. Be specific: name the idea from this week that does the connecting and describe how it connects to that field.

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

THREAD

Pick one of the disciplines that you listed above. Come up with a question based on it, or follow a thread that you are interested in.

For example, I learned from an article in my news feed that the color of the ocean is changing due to climate change.

<https://news.mit.edu/2023/study-oceans-color-changing-climate-change-0712> This sits in many disciplines, including biology.

Once you learn something new in this new field, apply that new idea to your speculative artwork idea from above. For example, in my scenario, my scene will now have a greenish sea.

Describe here: the discipline, the thing you learned, and how it can be applied to your speculative artwork.

Write your answer here. This box keeps growing as you type.

SLIDE CREATION SECTION

Use this section to help plan your slide or slides.

SLIDE TITLE

Name the idea in a few words.

THE LINE, AS IT WILL APPEAR

Paste a line from one of your answers above, then edit it freely.

WHAT IS IT? SAY IT WITH CONVICTION

What the image shows, and what it has to do with the line above.

YOUR DRAWING OR IMAGE

Paste your image into this box, or note here what you will place on the slide.

SLIDE CREATION

Now you will make your slides.

MAKE SLIDES

1. Use this template to create your slide or slides. ([<https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/16smg32MXcOo17cr7HPGipkYCuv9Dze6ps0ovNUCsuoC/edit?slide=id.p3#slide=id.p3>])
2. Make a copy of the file before you start editing it.
3. Your presentation must be 1 minute or less.
4. You don't have to use my template; it is just a starting place if you need it.